

Apple Inc.

Overview

Apple Inc. is a **Large Public** firm based in **Cupertino, CA**. They perform **Consumer electronics, software, and digital health platform development** for **Global consumers, clinical researchers, and health system partners**.

Apple's expansion into clinical-grade health monitoring through Apple Watch, HealthKit, ResearchKit, and the forthcoming Health+ AI coaching platform creates direct alignment with UNC's strengths in biomedical informatics, decentralized clinical trial infrastructure, and consumer health data research.

Apple Scholars in AI/ML Program (nominated through UNC) is the best avenue for partnership because Apple's PhD fellowship program operates through university nomination, making UNC's informatics faculty a direct pipeline to a formal Apple research relationship. UNC's fit with Apple's stated focus areas — AI for Health and Wellness, Privacy Preserving Machine Learning, and Human Centered AI — is strong.

Basic Company Information

- **Name, Company Location:** Apple Inc., Cupertino, CA
- **Company Website URL:** apple.com
- **Company Type, Company Size:** Public, Large (approx. 150,000 employees)

Company Type

- **IPO?** Yes (NASDAQ: AAPL) — 1980

Company Size

- **Large:** 150,000+

Talking Points

- **Health+ AI Platform Launch:** Apple is launching Health+ in 2026, an AI-powered subscription health coaching platform that integrates Apple Watch sensor data, HealthKit records, and clinical data to deliver personalized chronic disease management and wellness guidance. [1]
- **ResearchKit and Decentralized Trial Infrastructure:** Apple's open-source ResearchKit framework has enabled academic medical centers to enroll tens of thousands of participants in mobile-first clinical studies on cardiovascular disease, diabetes,

Parkinson's disease, and asthma. UNC Health's decentralized trial capabilities are a natural fit for ResearchKit-based study design. [2]

- **Privacy-Preserving Machine Learning:** Apple's ML research program funds university partnerships explicitly in privacy-preserving ML and AI for Health and Wellness — two areas directly aligned with UNC's biomedical informatics research and IRB-governed health data infrastructure. [3]
- **Apple Scholars PhD Fellowship Pipeline:** Apple's Scholars in AI/ML fellowship operates through university nomination and funds doctoral students in AI for Health, Human Centered AI, and Privacy Preserving ML. UNC's graduate programs in biomedical and health informatics are eligible and well-positioned to nominate candidates. [4]
- **Wearables Revenue and Health Data Scale:** Apple's Wearables, Home, and Accessories segment generated \$35.7 billion in FY2025 revenue. With hundreds of millions of Apple Watch units deployed globally, the scale of longitudinal health data accessible through HealthKit represents a research resource with no academic parallel. [5]

References

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